Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto, where assigned projects run from scoping to recommendations. Coordinates consultants, divisions and outside agencies, tracks the work against schedule, and writes the briefing notes that carry issues and options to senior staff. Previously simulated GO rail operations at Metrolinx.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work, holding the schedule and quality myself, and reporting progress to the people relying on it.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Review development applications and the studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.
- Analyze network data to work out where capacity is short, and what that means for maintenance and capital spending.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Project coordination across consultants and divisions. Reports, presentations and briefing materials. Python, SQL and advanced Excel. ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, AutoCAD and Civil 3D. Synchro, VISSIM and OpenTrack. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)